

DAY 1

The Role of a Project Manager

Learning Objectives:

- Understand what a Project Manager does day-to-day across different industries
- Learn the difference between a PM, a Scrum Master, and a Product Owner Understand the project lifecycle: Initiation, Planning, Execution, Monitoring, Closure Learn the core responsibilities: scope, time, cost, quality, risk, and stakeholder management
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "What does a Project Manager do" — TED-style explainer
 - "Project Manager vs Product Manager vs Scrum Master"
 - "Project lifecycle explained for beginners"
 - "PMBOK vs Agile vs Scrum — which methodology to use"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - Google Project Management Certificate (Coursera)
 - PMC Lounge · TED-Ed

Tasks:

- Read about the PMBOK Guide and the 5 process groups — understand what each phase means in a real project
- Research 3 different PM methodologies: Waterfall, Agile, and Hybrid — write a short note on when each is used and why
- Find a real job description for a Junior PM role — list every skill mentioned, then mark which ones you already have and which ones you will build during this internship
- Write a one-page document titled "What I understand about the PM role" in your own words — cover what a PM does, what they don't do, and why they are critical to project success

Deliverable:

- One-page "PM Role Understanding" document Job description analysis note — skills you have vs skills to build
- Short note comparing Waterfall vs Agile vs Hybrid

What I Understand About the Project Manager Role

A Project Manager (PM) is responsible for planning, organizing, and managing a project from start to finish. The main goal of a PM is to ensure that the project is completed on time, within budget, and according to the required quality standards. A PM works with different teams, stakeholders, and clients to make sure everyone is aligned and moving toward the same objective.

The project lifecycle generally consists of five phases: Initiation, Planning, Execution, Monitoring and Controlling, and Closure. During initiation, the project goals and requirements are identified. In the planning phase, schedules, budgets, resources, and risks are planned. During execution, the team performs the actual work. Monitoring involves tracking progress and solving issues, while closure marks the completion of the project and documentation of lessons learned.

A Project Manager is responsible for managing scope, time, cost, quality, risks, resources, communication, and stakeholder expectations. They coordinate team activities, monitor project performance, identify potential risks, and ensure smooth communication among all involved parties.

However, a PM does not usually perform all the technical work themselves. For example, in a software project, developers write code and testers perform testing, while the PM ensures that these activities are completed according to the project plan. The PM guides the team and removes obstacles rather than doing every task personally.

Project Managers are critical to project success because they provide structure, coordination, and direction. Without effective project management, projects may face delays, budget overruns, poor communication, and unmet objectives. By managing resources, risks, and stakeholder expectations effectively, a PM helps ensure that project goals are successfully achieved.

PMBOK 5 Process Groups

1. **Initiating** - Define project goals and obtain approval.
2. **Planning** - Create schedules, budgets, resource plans, and risk plans.
3. **Executing** - Perform the project work.
4. **Monitoring & Controlling** - Track progress and manage changes.
5. **Closing** - Complete deliverables, obtain approvals, and document lessons learned.

Job Description Analysis Note

Sample Junior Project Manager Skills

A typical Junior PM job description includes: Excellent communication and teamwork abilities, enabling effective collaboration with cross-functional teams and stakeholders. Experienced in problem-solving and leadership, with the ability to guide teams toward successful project outcomes. Proficient in documentation, Microsoft Excel, and PowerPoint for reporting, analysis, and presentations. Possesses basic technical knowledge along with strong time management skills to handle multiple priorities efficiently. Familiar with Agile and Scrum practices, stakeholder management, risk assessment, project scheduling, resource allocation, budget tracking, and project status reporting. Skilled in using project management tools such as Jira and Trello to plan, track, and deliver projects effectively

Skills I Already Have	Skills I Will Build During This Internship
• Communication • Teamwork • Problem Solving • Leadership Experience • Documentation • Excel and PowerPoint • Basic Technical Knowledge • Time Management	• Agile and Scrum Practices • Stakeholder Management • Risk Assessment • Project Scheduling • Resource Allocation • Budget Tracking • Jira/Trello Usage • Project Status Reporting

Comparison of Waterfall, Agile, and Hybrid Methodologies

Waterfall Methodology

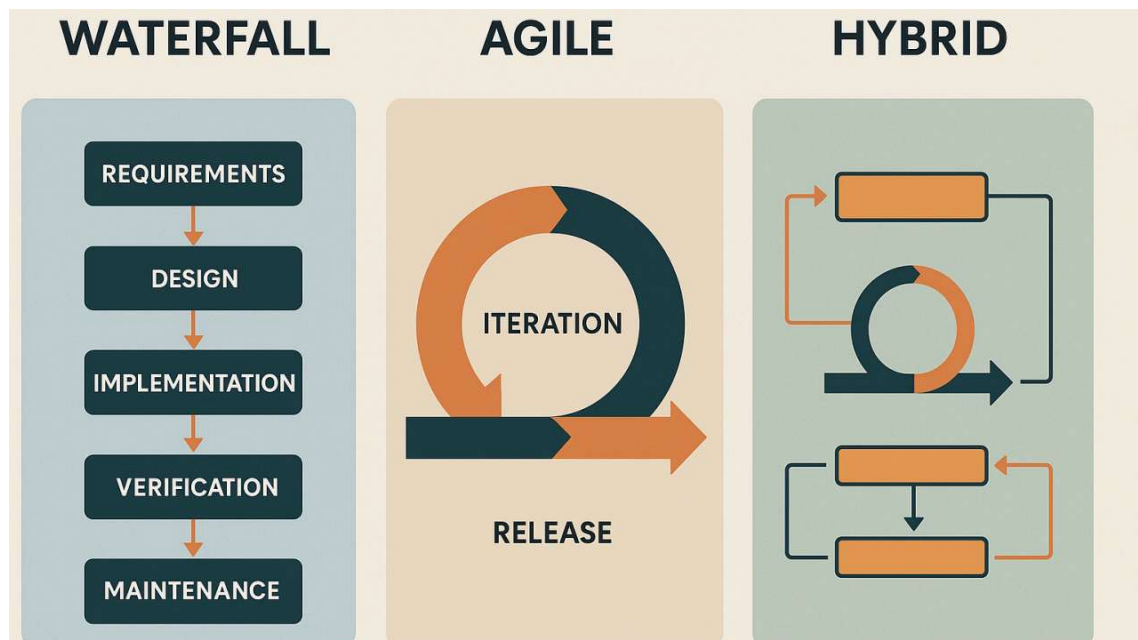
Waterfall follows a sequential approach where each phase is completed before the next phase begins. Requirements are defined at the start and changes are difficult to make later.

When Used

- Construction projects
- Manufacturing projects
- Government projects with fixed requirements

Why Used

It provides clear planning, documentation, and predictable outcomes when requirements are stable.



Agile Methodology

Agile follows an iterative approach where work is divided into small increments called sprints. Teams receive continuous feedback and can adapt to changing requirements.

When Used

- Software development
- Startup projects
- Product development with changing requirements

Why Used

It offers flexibility, faster feedback, and continuous improvement.

Hybrid Methodology

Hybrid combines elements of both Waterfall and Agile. Some parts of the project follow a structured plan while others use iterative Agile practices.

When Used

- Large enterprise projects
- Digital transformation projects
- Projects involving both business and technical teams

Why Used

It balances predictability with flexibility, making it suitable for complex projects with both fixed and changing requirements.

Conclusion

Waterfall is best when requirements are fixed, Agile is best when requirements change frequently, and Hybrid is useful when a project needs both structure and adaptability.